

Why you are here

This engagement was commissioned jointly by your two main stakeholders, Home and Work. It is the first thing they have ever agreed on without a meeting. Home is represented by Lauren, your wife. Work is represented by Priya, a senior partner at your firm, who plays tennis and would like that noted.

The brief is short. Over the last eighteen months you have mentioned padel in 94% of conversations lasting longer than four minutes. The other 6% were phone calls with the bank, and in two of those you asked the adviser whether she played. You have said "the fastest-growing sport in the world" 212 times, once to a midwife. Nobody is asking you to stop playing. Home and Work would simply like to know what else you think about, and they have paid for this engagement to find out.

The programme runs in nine phases, from Scoping to Sign-off. Each has exercises, a short assessment and feedback from your stakeholders. You will be tempted to treat the assessments like a padel ranking and try to top them. Please don't. The only good score in this book is a low one.

STAKEHOLDER FEEDBACK (HOME), WEEK ONE

Asked him how the nursery settling-in session went. He said Mia "read the room really well, like a good bandeja". Then he explained the bandeja. Alfie was eating a crayon at the time and Josh did not notice, because he was drawing the court on a napkin to show me the angles.

STAKEHOLDER FEEDBACK (WORK), WEEK ONE

Monday stand-up. Josh opened with a quick padel stat before the client update. The client update was about a client who was not happy with us. The padel stat was about a club in Leeds.